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SETTING THE BRAKE ON ALIEN MEDDLING

The New England town meeting is one of the oldest existing vehicles of democracy—as old as the United States government itself.

So when a New England town meeting comes into head-on collision with the ultra-modern phenomenon of Nazism, what happens ought to be worth watching.

It happened, the other day—in Southbury, Conn. The German-American Bund, a Nazi outfit, had bought 178 acres of land within the town limits of Southbury, and was preparing to build a camp there. The sturdy Yankee of Southbury had scant use for such goings-on, and cast about for a way to stop it. Hence the town meeting.

The townspeople debated the matter for a couple of hours or so. On the one hand, they faced the fact that this is a free country and that there is no law to keep a private organization from maintaining a summer camp if it chooses to do so; on the other hand, there was the equally obvious fact that Yankee democracy has no use whatever for a goose-stepping, heil-Hitlerling Nazi outfit in its midst.

In the end, the townspeople adopted a zoning ordinance making it illegal for the Nazis to build cabins or hold drills on their land. And there the matter rests, with the Nazis apparently checkmated.

* * *

Now Southbury is a small town, and what happens there may not seems to be of very great moment as far as capitals like Washington and Berlin are concerned. But there was a good deal of significance in this town meeting, for it grappled with a problem that is peculiarly difficult for Americans to handle—as well as increasingly important.

That problem has to do with the treatment which we are to give to semi-political organizations, inspired by foreign propagandists and aiming ultimately at the complete denial of everything we understand by Americanism. The Nazis are one such group; the Communists are another. Each looks forward to the abolition of democracy, each scoffs at freedom—and yet each is quick to take advantage of our democratic freedom in order to carry on its program in our midst.

What are we to do in such cases? Our laws guaranteeing freedom of speech, freedom of assembly, and so on, are extremely precious to us. Yet it is not pleasant to see those laws used as a protective cloak by the very people who would immediately destroy them if they should get in power.

* * *

The Yankee ingenuity of the Southbury town meeting found one answer. A zoning ordinance may be a queer weapon with which to fight a potential dictatorship, but apparently it is going to do the job the Southbury people want it to do.

A more comprehensive answer is needed, however. We have a right to protect ourselves. Evolving a method of applying that protection within the framework of our free institutions calls for some earnest thinking.

MEMORY LANE

NINE YEARS AGO
December, 21, 1928

C. J. Calmes is spending the week-end in Oklahoma City.

T. J. Harris, who is employed with the Rainey Davis Merchantile company, of Pratt, Kans., will spend the Christmas holidays in Clinton, visiting his family.

Miss Vera Cooper and Mr. and Mrs. Nolan Bell will spend the week-end in Oklahoma City.

Miss Marie Harris, who is employed as a teacher at Fay, Okla., will spend the Christmas holidays in Clinton with her parents, Mr. and Mrs. T. J. Harris.

The epidemic of influenza that spread through the city of Clinton and neighboring territory like wildfire several weeks ago, reached the peak of its progress last week, and is now definitely on the wane, local physicians expressed Friday morning.

DAILY NEWS WANT-ADS GET RESULTS

GRIN AND BEAR IT — By LICHTY

"It's that awful Smith dog howling again. We simply must have a baby and give them a taste of their own medicine!"

BEHIND THE SCENES IN WASHINGTON
BY RODNEY DUTCHER

BY RODNEY DUTCHER
NEA Service Staff Correspondent

WASHINGTON.—More than 1,500,000 persons have lost their jobs since Labor Day and about 1,700,000 have had their working hours—and hence their purchasing power—curtailed.

At least 2,475,000 persons who were at work in August will be out of work by the third week in January.

These secret estimates as to the effect of the current business recession on employment have been carefully worked out by some of the government's foremost economists and statisticians.

Officially, of course, it is stated that there's no way of telling the amount of new unemployment. Actually, there has been some real effort to find out where the country stands and what relief needs may amount to next winter and spring.

Indications are that 950,000 persons have been laid off by factories since the beginning of September, about 275,000 in the construction industry and around 210,000 in the transportation and mining industries. That adds up to 1,435,000 and, if the figures are approximately correct, there are other jobless in addition.

The estimated 1,700,000 whose employment has been cut down to two, three or four days a week are an important factor in the business situation because the resultant decline in purchasing power accentuates the present downward spiral.

More layoffs are anticipated after Christmas. Many now working in the retail, wholesale and mail order trade will be released. Others now working part-time in industry are expected to go off payrolls entirely. Some employers who have deliberately refrained from pre-Christmas layoffs will finally break the news. And by the middle of January, it's computed, agricultural unemployment—largely seasonal—will have reached 450,000.

The previously cited estimate of 2,475,000 may be conservative. Some government economists believe that the number of "new unemployed" will reach 3,000,000 by the middle of January.

The federal unemployment census directed by John D. Biggers was taken right in the middle of the September-January period and consequently will reflect only partially the effect of the business slump.

Accuracy of this count will depend largely on the care with which questionnaire replies are checked as to whether they report actual unemployment.

* * *

BY the first of the year, WPA rolls will be carrying nearly 2,000,000 persons and will reach the peak limit which Administrator Harry Hopkins says is possible under the 1937-38 appropriation of $1,500,000,000, it now appears. WPA employment is now about 1,575,000 and is increasing rapidly as 350,000 more persons begin to be added to the rolls.

Congressmen returning from the holidays are expected to increase the pressure already begun by some of them for an additional WPA appropriation. The degree of this pressure is likely to be conditioned by the speed or lag with which the increase in unemployment is reflected on local relief rolls, and the extent to which unemployment insurance systems in nearly half the states serve to keep the "new unemployed" off those rolls.

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THIS CURIOUS WORLD — By William Ferguson

TUBERCULOSIS attacks different races in different ways. American Indians, on leaving the outdoor life to which they are accustomed, and moving to congested cities, are notoriously susceptible to the disease.

KELLOGG SAID TO BE BETTER

ST. PAUL, Minn., Dec. 21.—(AP)—Dr. J. A. Lepak, said Frank B. Kellogg, co-author of the Kellogg-Briand peace pact, critically ill at his home here with pneumonia, had rallied today.

The physician said spread of the congestion had been halted and that his heart action was better. He held out "virtually no hope" for recovery, however.

Kellogg, an internationally known diplomat, is a former ambassador to Great Britain, world court judge and secretary of state.

Daily News PARADE

Highway Patrolman Roy Russell arrested a drunk driver the other day. When ordinary method of persuasion failed to gain his release, the drunk confided in Patrolman Russell that he was going to see Governor Marland.

"I'll have him appoint me inspector of the patrol," said the man under arrest. "Then you'll be sorry. I'll sure get your uniform."

Patrolman Russell was not alarmed, however, for that is one of the favorite lines of argument with the drivers. And threats never help a bit.

* * *

When Chairman Lea M. Nichols of the state board of affairs announced the ouster of Dr. J. A. Land as sanatorium superintendent, he told reporters "I think the less said of this the better."

We disagree.

We think it should be publicized sufficiently to impress upon the legislators who are responsible that frequent changes in the administration of the sanatorium is very definitely a poor policy.

We think, and have thought all along, that the board should select a capable man to head the institution, and leave him there.

Changing a superintendent after only two months, as has been done in the Dr. Land case, is almost the last straw.

We hope the appointment of Dr. W. C. Tisdal is permanent.

NEW YORK INSIDE OUT

NEW YORK, Dec. 21.—Movie stars who come to New York for a "vacation" really crowd in enough business, during their stay, to stymie a big corporation executive. Joan Crawford, now installed at the Waldorf, has three secretaries along to help wade through the endless details she must transact. ....As a matter of fact, you never see a film star in Manhattan who doesn't have at least two publicity agents constantly at her side, escorting her from place to place with the remorseless precision of a railroad time-table. I once happened to get into a heated discussion with Fay Wray over the merits of a current Broadway drama. It was in a private reception room at the Hotel Gotham, and for a moment we forgot the professional interview which had been the original starting point....Just when the argument got interesting, two firm-handed film representatives hustled Miss Wray into her coat with a reminder that she was due at another spot in ten minutes. She had to chop off a sentence in the middle as she disappeared through the elevator door....What with shopping, meeting managers, posing for newsmen, wrangling with agents and appearing at the proper night clubs, the New York "relaxation" is a nightmare. Karen Morley once told me that only the vainest stars looked on these visits without real dread.

N'YAWKERS

Big Snapshots: Ira Gershwin arguing vociferously with the manager of the swanky Central Park West apartment house where he lives. Ira was threatened only the other day with a dispossess notice because he keeps playing the piano after 11 o'clock. Neighbors complain they like Ira's stuff in the movies, but not when they want to sleep....Former Mayor Jimmie Walker buying a ticket at a Broadway newsreel theatre. Walker holds up the line while he chats with the cashier about farm life....Elmer Rice filing solemnly into the jury box at a murder trial las week in Supreme Court. Rice won fame as a playwright with his first opus, "On Trial," a courtroom drama. He himself started out as a criminal lawyer....Jascha Heifetz, world-famous violin virtuoso, drawing lots of craned necks from the crowd in La Conga the other night. Heifetz sits dutifully near one of the orchestra players and takes a lesson on how to play the maracas, a Cuban rattle....Eve Symington, the social registerite who warbles nightly in the Waldorf Astoria Sert Room, clapping her hand over her mouth at a Madison Square Garden hockey game. Eve and her husband are enthusiastic hockey fans, but she can't risk spoiling her voice by yelling during the exciting rallies.

IMPROMPTUS

Ether Echoes: Fred Allen's original name was Sullivan. As a lad he thought Smith was the most common name in the country; but while working as a runner in the Boston Public Library he discovered that the city directory listed 43 more Sullivans than Smiths.... With so many in town, Fred thought he'd better change, to Fred St. James. There was several more changes before he finally assumed the Allen tag....Incidentally, Fred cannot type, and so he writes all his scripts out by hand with electric speed. His handwriting is so microscopic in size that nobody can read the scripts except himself....All cast members of the "Aunt Jenny" show drop a quarter into the kitty every time they muff a cue or miss a line. The proceeds go to the Christmas fund for poor children....Sound effect imitations of Jack Benny trying to start his old Maxwell are done by Pinto Colvig, aided by the south end of a slip horn. Colvig was once a character actor at Walt Disney's Silly Symphony studio....Ona Hiersche[illegible] takes [illegible] snapshots of the "Song Shop" cast during rehearsals—then drives them cuh-razy because he won't show them the pictures later, the meanie!

'WHAT CAN BE IN THIS ONE?' THEY CRIED

BARBS

IT'S only after the battle's over and the home town has put up his statue in the library that a man realizes fame is just a bust.

Japan's ultimatum to Nanking contained, it is reliably reported, the threat to maintain Far East peace at any price.

* * *

School children are getting wiser. A midwest teacher asked where The Hague is located and one bright urchin shouted "New Jersey."

* * *

Russian parachute practice is carried on under the theory that everyone in the nation is just two jumps from a big war.

An oldtimer in Philadelphia has been caught yearning for the old days when good five-cent cigars were a dime a dozen.

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MILL SECTION SUFFERS LOSS

TSINGTAO, China, Dec. 20—(UP)—Renewal of a wave of looting, dynamiting and burning which caused $100,000,000 loss in the Japanese mill section was feared tonight.

Acting upon the orders of the state department at Washington, the U. S. consul warned all Americans to evacuate quickly although American flags and property have not been endangered. Some Americans have left for Shanghai but the majority are determined to stay.

The new communistic tinge of the Chinese government at Hankow was blamed by some observers for the terrorism here. They pointed out that three communist leaders were appointed members of the national military council, China's highest military power.

They believed that the dynamiting possibly ushered in an entirely new Chinese war party in which aggressive counter offensive action, including the blowing up of Japanese property throughout China, will be pursued.

It is a good habit to read the Clinton Daily News.

TOO MANY FIANCEES
by KATHRYN CULVER

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Guy Garrison's millionaire Uncle Sherman, irascible invalid, is so insistent upon his getting married that Guy, while wintering in Miami, sends the old man a photo of Joan Wilson, night-club singer, saying he is engaged to her. Then, he actually becomes engaged to Mabel Lane but, when Uncle Sherman comes to Miami to take him and Joan on a yacht cruise, Guy is afraid to spring a new fiancee on him. He pays Joan to go on the cruise as his "fiancee." Ned Acton, who loves Joan and is opposed to the scheme, gets aboard the yacht as a member of the crew. Also aboard are Dick Young, private detective, and Laura Miller, pretty trained nurse. At Havana, Ned mysteriously skips. That evening, while the yacht party is at the gambling Casino, Laura is decoyed away from the others by an anonymous note. A strange Cuban kidnaps her and takes her to a deserted house, where he locks her in an upstairs room.

CHAPTER XXIV

LAURA'S first impulse on being left a prisoner in the huge, high-ceilinged room, was to scream hysterically, but she gritted her teeth to repress the impulse. Instinctively, she knew that screams would do her no good. Her captor would not have left her ungagged if there was any chance that anyone would pay any attention to cries for help.

She sank into a deep armchair trying to fight off the hideous fear that threatens to engulf her. Someone would come soon. The Cuban had indicated as much. She must steel herself for the meeting.

Who would come? And what did they intend to do with her?

She rose nervously and went to a front window. It was old-fashioned, with a heavy wooden frame and small leaded panes of glass. Outside, were horizontal iron bars imbedded in the solid masonry.

The window came open as she struggled with it. A blast of cool air whipped into the room, refreshing her fevered brow.

She grasped one of the iron bars and shook it tentatively. It was as solid as the house itself. Pressing her forehead against the cold metal she could look down into the street, and could see the houses on either side of her prison.

The street was dark and deserted. The houses on each side were a good hundred feet away and not a glimmer of light showed in either of them.

SHE turned away from the window. A careful tour of the room convinced her that there was no possible escape except by the door—and it was solid oak, without even a transom above. The walls were solid, and there was not even a closet to give hope of another exit. No skylight in the ceiling and no rugs on the floor to conceal a possible trapdoor.

The room's furnishings were a queer mingling of the ancient and the modern. The house must be very old, Laura thought, with its high ceilings and the bastion-like alcove between the front windows. There was a beautiful cut-glass chandelier suspended from the ceiling with holders for two dozen candles, but an ugly bare electric bulb had superseded candles for illumination.

A silk-covered divan was placed invitingly in the alcove, an intruding note of modernity among the high-backed, carved chairs and the antique chest of draw[illegible] with the patina of age upon [illegible] rubbed surface.

Laura went to the divan [illegible] sat down stiffly, staring at [illegible] locked door with brooding e[illegible] Soon, the knob would turn, [illegible] the door would open inward.

Hysteria threatened to c[illegible] upon her again. She resolu[illegible] averted her eyes from the d[illegible] forced herself to think about [illegible] gay party she had left at [illegible] Casino.

WHAT had they thought of [illegible] disappearance? How lo[illegible] would they wait before institu[illegible] a search for her? She little k[illegible] of the spurious message that [illegible] been delivered to them. She [illegible] serenely confident that Dick w[illegible] not return to the yacht with[illegible] her.

She realized that most of [illegible] thoughts were of Dick. A w[illegible] glow replaced the chill of hyst[illegible] as she said his name softly al[illegible]

They had all been playin[illegible] game aboard the *Nirvana*. [illegible] had played her role by pretend[illegible] to ignore Dick's advances. Bu[illegible] had been difficult. From the [illegible] ment of meeting him, she [illegible] been acutely aware of his inte[illegible] in her—and of her awakening [illegible] terest in him.

She hadn't allowed herself [illegible] do much thinking about it w[illegible] aboard the yacht. There, she [illegible] had her work to do. Mr. Garri[illegible] had been a trying patient. [illegible] his care had left her little time [illegible] personal affairs.

She sighed forlornly, and s[illegible] denly realized that she was thi[illegible] ing about it all as though it w[illegible] of the past. For the first time [illegible] faced the realization that [illegible] might never seen any of the va[illegible] party again!

The others didn't matter. [illegible] not seeing Dick again matte[illegible] terribly. Mr. Garrison would [illegible] along without her—much be[illegible] without her, she told herself w[illegible] ly. She envisioned him defia[illegible] smoking a cigar, taking a co[illegible] tail. She knew any such ex[illegible] might snap the slender thr[illegible] that held him to life but, in [illegible] heart, she felt he might be h[illegible] pier to go that way.

She felt so removed from it [illegible] as though it were a part of her [illegible] that was dead. She tried to [illegible] the morbid fancy away from [illegible]

SHE jumped up and began [illegible] pace the floor, wondering [illegible] much longer she could endure [illegible] torture of waiting — how m[illegible] longer she would *have* to endure[illegible]

At the sound of an approach[illegible] car in the street, she ran to [illegible] window, hoping frantically t[illegible] she might make herself hear[illegible] then clung to the bars with [illegible] hope gone as the automobile d[illegible] up in front of the house [illegible] stopped.

One man got out, walked bris[illegible] up the walk. Laura heard [illegible] front door open and close. Th[illegible] was a brief interlude of silenc[illegible] then the tread of heavy feet [illegible] the stairs.

She drew back fearfully, crou[illegible] ed in a corner, her lips dry, [illegible] heart pounding furiously. [illegible] key grated in the lock . . . the k[illegible] turned, and the door swung [illegible] ward.

For a moment, she didn't rec[illegible] nize the man who stood in [illegible] doorway, his eyes searching [illegible] room. She didn't recognize [illegible] until a bellow of astonished r[illegible] burst from his lips:

"What the devil are you d[illegible] here!"

(To be continued)

(The characters in this serial are fictitious.)